



## PROCEDURE

### Role of the Allocated Nurse – MH Inpatient Services

|                       |                                                     |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Scope (Staff):</b> | All NMHS Mental Health (MH) Staff: Nursing          |
| <b>Scope (Area):</b>  | All NMHS MH Areas: Inpatient Mental Health Services |

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## 1. Aim

North Metropolitan Health Service (NMHS) Mental Health (MH) is committed to ensuring a nurse with the appropriate level of skill and experience is allocated to provide care that is safe and therapeutic. Enrolled nurses allocated to this role work under the supervision of a registered nurse.

## 2. Background

NMHS MH promotes and encourages positive, recovery focused attitudes towards mental illness, including the knowledge that people can and will recover and live positive lives while making meaningful contributions to the community. Person-centred care is central to the recovery-focused approach to improve mental health service delivery. In order for this to occur a nurse with the appropriate experience and competencies to meet the patient's needs will be allocated and be accountable for overseeing the care of the patient for each shift.

The allocated nurse will adhere to the principles of trauma informed, strengths-based, individualised, person-centred care that are the fundamental concepts of partnership and collaboration between health care professionals and patients, families and carers as identified in the [NMHS MH Clinical Risk Assessment and Management \(CRAM\) Policy](#), the [MH Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration \(RRAD\) Policy](#) and the Treatment Support and Discharge Plan (TSDP).

### 3. Risk

Adherence to this procedure provides guidance for nurses in the safe clinical management of the patient and reinforces the requirement to deliver person-centred, trauma informed care that is aligned to the fundamental concepts of partnership and collaboration between health care professionals and patients, families and carers. Non-compliance with this procedure will impact on the following risk categories:

|                                       |                                     |                                 |                                     |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Culture                               | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Organisational Development      | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| Emergency Management                  | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Policy & Legislative Compliance | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Fiscal Responsibility                 | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Quality of Patient Care         | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Governance & Accountability           | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Research & Innovation           | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| Information Communications Technology | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Staff Safety & Wellness         | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Facility Management                   | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Workforce Planning              | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| Medical Equipment                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Other                           | <input type="checkbox"/>            |

### 4. Principles

Wherever possible the allocation of a nurse will take into consideration cultural diversity needs and individual preferences as identified in the [National Standards for Mental Health Services](#), the [Chief Psychiatrist's Sexual Safety Guidelines](#) and the [Charter of Mental Health Care Principles \(MHA 2014\)](#).

Collaborative strategies will be implemented to maximise the safety of patients who are identified as being vulnerable for any reason including at risk of being sexually unsafe in accordance with the [MH Sexual Safety in Inpatient Services Guideline](#).

Allocated nurses must ensure that the rights of consumers, families and carers are met in accordance with the [Charter of Mental Health Care Principles \(MHA 2014\)](#)

Allocated nurses follow the [WA DoH Clinical Handover Policy](#) and the [Clinical Handover Matrix](#) and adhere to the [National Safety & Quality Healthcare Standard \(NSQHS\) 6: Communicating for Safety](#) and will use the iSoBAR framework for clinical handover and transfer of clinical information to ensure effective communication and safe, person-centred coordinated care.

Allocated nurses work in accordance with the Nurses and Midwives Board of [Australia National Framework for the Development of Decision Making](#), the [AHPRA Standards for Enrolled and Registered Nurses and Code of Conduct](#).

Allocated nurses receive orientation and are familiar with the ward environment including the location of emergency alarms, fire exits, and emergency activation protocols and are required to carry a Personal Duress Alarm in accordance with the requirements of the [WA Work Health and Safety Act 2020](#) and [WA Work Health and Safety Regulations 2022](#).

Allocated nurses provide a high level of therapeutic engagement by spending quality time with patients using [engagement-focused observations and interactions](#) that aim to empower the patient to actively participate in their care. A high level of therapeutic engagement is evident in units with a dynamic ward culture grounded in having empathy for patients and supporting staff.

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## 5. Allocation Process

Allocation for each shift will be determined by the senior nurse in charge who will consider the following as part of the allocation process.

- Level of skills, competencies and experience required to meet the needs of allocated patients.
- Complexity of care requirements for individual patients taking in to account legal status, age, risk factors, acuity, comorbidities, vulnerability, planned treatments, booked appointments, admission, discharge and transfer.
- Ward acuity as determined by the number of patients assessed as high-risk, number of patients on clinical observations (level 1 and level 2) requiring a high level of therapeutic engagement, number of planned treatments, appointments, admissions, discharges and transfers.
- Assessment of nursing staffing levels and experience, physical environment impacts and safety considerations.
- Allocating a nurse of the same gender as the patient to provide cultural security, sexual safety and nursing care requirements when requested by the patient.
- Other considerations such as allied health, administrative and medical staff shortages directly impacting nursing workloads.

## 6. Roles and Responsibilities of the Allocated Nurse

The Allocated Nurse will undertake the following duties and responsibilities:

- Inform the patient that as their allocated nurse for the shift they have responsible for the coordination of patient care and will meet regularly to provide care, review progress and respond to any queries or concerns.
- Undertake the level of clinical observation as ordered, reviews physical and mental health parameters and undertakes a risk assessment and other prescribed interventions following medical review. (Refer to the [MH Clinical Observation Procedure](#) and the [MH Clinical Risk Assessment and Management Policy](#)).
- Familiarise themselves with prescribed patient medications (routine and PRN) and other prescribed treatments and providing patient medication education.
- Administer medications and treatments for allocated patients in accordance with the requirements of the [NMHS MH Medication Prescribing, Administration and Management for Inpatients Policy](#).
- Consult with the patient, carers and/or significant others and members of the multidisciplinary team to identify the health needs of the patient as documented in the [Consumer Safety Plan](#) (CSP) and the [Treatment Support and Discharge Plan](#) (TSDP).
- Update the MH Observation and Response Chart (ORC) and if concerned escalate physical health care for senior nurse review in accordance with the [MH Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration \(RRAD\) Policy](#).

- Complete the Observation and Response Chart (PMR38) for allocated patients on each shift as required in accordance with the MH Clinical Observation Procedure.
- Clinical information relating to each patient is recorded by the allocated nurse in the integrated Progress Notes at a minimum of once per shift and in the TSDP in accordance with [SSCD](#) requirements and the [MH Clinical Record Documentation Procedure](#)
- Attend clinical handover, review the patient's Treatment Support and Discharge Plan (TSDP), Consumer Safety Plan and relevant information including risks, alerts and special considerations or care requirements (noting past trauma and agreed strategies).
- Escalate care for senior nurse/medical review in response to safety concerns or identification of deteriorating mental health requiring completion of the MH Agitation and Arousal Chart (**PMR60**) in accordance with the [MH Clinical Risk and Management Policy](#) (CRAM) and the [MH Clinical Observation Procedure](#).
- In an emergency situation the allocated nurse may activate an emergency response (Code Blue and / or Code Black) to alert team members in accordance with the [MH Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration Policy](#), the [MH Clinical Risk and Management Policy](#) and relevant [MH Emergency Management Procedures](#).
- Ensure that clinical documentation is compliant with the requirements of the Mental Health Act (2014) and is accurately documented in accordance with the [WA Health Mental Health Framework for State-wide Standardised Clinical Documentation: Triage to Discharge](#), the [NMHS Clinical Documentation Policy](#) and the [MH Clinical Record Management Procedure](#) and summarised in the integrated progress notes.
- Provide clinical handover for allocated patients on a shift by shift basis in accordance with the iSoBAR (**Appendix 1**) format and [DoH Clinical Handover Policy](#) and the [Clinical Handover Matrix](#) reporting any changes in physical or mental health status including any risks or concerns identified and follow up action required

## 7. Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Compliance with this procedure will be monitored through Safety and Quality audits and medication audits.

MHPHDS Safety, Quality and Performance Unit is responsible for audit management and tables audit reports at the Service Leadership Committees and Clinical Management Executive Group for review of findings.

### Related internal policies, procedures and guidelines

[NMHS Clinical Care of People who may be Suicidal Policy](#)

[NMHS Clinical Documentation Policy](#)

[MH Clinical Record Documentation Procedure](#)

[MH Sexual Safety in Inpatient Services Guideline](#)

[NMHS Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration Policy](#)

[NMHS Mandatory Training Policy](#)  
[MHPHDS Mandatory Training Policy](#)  
[NMHS MH Clinical Risk Assessment and Management Policy](#)  
[NMHS MH Medication Prescribing, Administration and Management for Inpatients](#)  
[NMHS Search of Patients, Visitors and their Property Policy](#)  
[NMHS MH Search of Person, Property, Environment and Seizure of Property Procedure](#)  
[NMHS MH Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration Policy](#)  
[NMHS MH Patient of Concern Protocol](#)  
[NMHS MH Clinical Observation Procedure](#)  
[NMHS MH Emergency Management](#)

## References

[DoH Safety Planning for Mental Consumers \(MP 0181/24\)](#)  
[Chief Psychiatrist's Standards](#)  
[Chief Psychiatrist's Sexual Safety Guidelines MH, Charter of Mental Health Care Principles, Mental Health Act 2014 and Regulations](#)  
[Charter of Mental Health Care Principles \(MHA 2014\).](#)  
[DoH Clinical Handover Policy and the Clinical Handover Matrix](#)  
[National Safety and Quality for Healthcare Standards Standard 6, Communicating for Safety.](#)  
[SSCD Statewide Standardised Clinical Documentation – Triage to Discharge](#)  
[WA Aboriginal Health and Wellbeing Framework 2015 - 2030](#)  
[Work Health and Safety \(WHS\) Act 2020 and WHS Regulations 2021](#)

## Useful resources

[MHPHDS Orientation and Induction Information](#)  
[Nursing and Midwifery Board – Professional Codes and Guidelines](#)  
[Recovery Oriented Language Guide Words Matter, Mental Health Coordinating Council 2022](#)  
[MHPHDS Audit Tools SQP - Audits](#)  
 MH Agitation and Arousal Chart PMR60  
 MH Observation and Response Chart PMR38

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------|--------------|------------|
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| Policy Contact                                                                                    | Director of Nursing MHPHDS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |            |              |            |
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| Endorsed by:                                                                                      | Director of Nursing MHPHDS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |            | Date:        | 03/05/2024 |
| NSQHS Standards Applicable:                                                                       | <div style="display: flex; justify-content: space-between;"> <div style="width: 48%;"> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/>  Std 1: Clinical Governance<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/>  Std 2: Partnering with Consumers<br/> <input type="checkbox"/>  Std 3: Preventing and Controlling Healthcare Associated Infection<br/> <input type="checkbox"/>  Std 4: Medication Safety </div> <div style="width: 48%;"> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/>  Std 5: Comprehensive Care<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/>  Std 6: Communicating for Safety<br/> <input type="checkbox"/>  Std 7: Blood Management<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/>  Std 8: Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration </div> </div> |                |            |              |            |
| National Standards for Mental Health Services                                                     | <div style="display: flex; justify-content: space-between;"> <div style="width: 48%;"> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Std 1: Rights and Responsibilities<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Std 2: Safety<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Std 3: Consumer and Carer Participation<br/> <input type="checkbox"/> Std 4: Diversity Responsibility<br/> <input type="checkbox"/> Std 5: Promotion and Prevention<br/> <input type="checkbox"/> Std 6: Consumers<br/> <input type="checkbox"/> Std 7: Carers<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Std 8: Governance, leadership, and management </div> <div style="width: 48%;"> <input type="checkbox"/> Std 9: Integration<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Std 10: Delivery of Care <div style="margin-left: 20px;"> <input type="checkbox"/> 10.1 Supporting Recovery<br/> <input type="checkbox"/> 10.2 Access<br/> <input type="checkbox"/> 10.3 Entry<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> 10.4 Assessment and Review<br/> <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> 10.5 Treatment and Support<br/> <input type="checkbox"/> 10.6 Exit and Re-entry </div> </div> </div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |            |              |            |
| Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care:                                                 | Care Planning,<br>Risk Assessment and Management,                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                |            |              |            |
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| Document Version Control |         |                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| Date                     | Version | Author                                      | Notes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 08/02/2019               | 2.0     | Nurse Director, Graylands Hospital, NMHS MH | Scheduled Review: Change of Policy Type from Policy to Nursing Practice Standard (NPS). Content revised and rewritten to improve clarity of information. Addition of Risk and Principles statement, compliance and evaluation section added, updated references and hyperlinks, updated template, updated NSQHS Standards in the Standards section |
| 19/01/2022               | 3.0     | Director of Nursing MHPHDS                  | Scheduled Review: Change in policy type from Nursing Practice Standard to Procedure. Content reviewed, updated references and hyperlinks and template.                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 14/06/2022               | 3.1     | A/Policy and Audit Officer                  | Minor amendment – updating links                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |



|            |     |                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------|-----|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 03/05/2024 | 4.0 | Director of Nursing MHPHDS | Procedure updated to inform nursing roles in providing direct patient contact inpatient services in line with the revised SS CD and Psolis documentation; the revised OCP documentation relating to the development of therapeutic alliance and engagement focused clinical observations and consistency with language and priorities identified in DOH, NMHS and MH policy. |
|------------|-----|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

The health impact upon Aboriginal people have been considered, and where relevant incorporated and appropriately addressed in the development of this health initiative (ISD Number: **789**).

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## Appendix: 1 iSoBAR Framework

| iSoBAR                 | Relevant Information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>I - Identify</b>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Client details/legal guardian/identification procedures</li><li>• Nurse handing over to incoming nurse</li><li>• Consent for services/information sharing</li></ul>                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>S - Situation</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Reason for handover/referral</li><li>• Presentation/ primary diagnosis</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>O - Observation</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Observations and assessment results</li><li>• Physical and Mental health assessments / tools</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>B - Background</b>  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• History / past admissions /presentations</li><li>• Medical/family history/Social situation/protective and risk factors</li><li>• Collateral information/Reports/Discharge Summaries</li><li>• Current reports/reviews /Risk assessments /treatments</li><li>• Medications/drug reactions/allergies</li></ul> |
| <b>A – Agreed Plan</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Given the situation, what needs to happen next?</li><li>• Risk management</li><li>• Relevant goals/plans/treatments</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>R – Readback</b>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Discuss handover/referral with parent/caregiver and confirm their understanding of process and required actions</li><li>• Identify receiving clinician and discuss handover/referral with them if required</li><li>• Receiving clinician – read electronic/paper based medical record</li></ul>              |